

sampling, which gives a definite result as to whether or not a condition is present.

TWIN TESTS

If you're expecting twins or more, blood-based screening tests for Down syndrome can mislead, since they rely on measuring the amounts of circulating AFP (alfa-fetoprotein) and other markers, which are present in much higher levels when there's more than one baby. That's why your best bet for screening is the [nuchal translucency test](#) at 11–14 weeks.